# ANCHOR

## A Plain-English Guide

Window & door install quoting — built for Florida contractors.

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# What's inside

This guide explains, in plain English, how every part of Anchor works and how the pieces fit together — so you can answer a customer's question on the spot, train a new salesperson, and trust the numbers. No code, no jargon — just how it thinks and why.

# 1. Quote / Cost Engine

*This is the brain behind every quote. You feed it the job details (linear footage of window frame, how many windows, the house and install type, any doors, plus your real material prices and crew pay), and it instantly works out what the job costs you and what to charge to hit your profit goal. Every number on the breakdown table, the per-foot rate, the grand total, and the selling price comes out of this one engine, and it recalculates the moment you change anything.*

### How it works

- It starts with the window linear footage you typed in. That window footage is the backbone of the whole estimate and is the only footage saved to the job and shown on the customer quote.
- For materials, it builds a separate 'material footage' number by adding any sliding-glass-door and bifold-door frame footage onto the window footage. This makes sure your screws, caulk, shims, and bucking cover the door frames too, without ever inflating the saved window footage (that double-counting bug is deliberately avoided).
- It then walks down your material list one item at a time and figures out how much of each you need per foot, multiplied by the material footage. Some items only kick in under the right conditions: nail-fin screws only on a nail-fin install; flashing tape only on stick-framed houses; wood bucking and extra concrete anchors only on block-framed houses; through-frame anchors and shims only on equal/unequal-leg installs.
- A few costs are flat instead of per-foot: a permit (only if you toggle it on), debris disposal charged per window (remodels only), and a lift rental charged per day (only on 2-plus-story jobs, with one extra day auto-added when a sliding or bifold door needs an inspection wait).
- Block sealer is special: on block-framed jobs it figures 5 gallons per 300 feet, always rounding up to the next full 5-gallon bucket.
- Wood bucking normally uses a per-foot estimate, but if you've run the AI cut list it switches to the exact board footage from that list instead.
- Doors are priced as whole units, not by the foot. Swing doors add frame-plus-hardware material, optional under-sill flashing, and extra anchors. Sliding and bifold doors add their own track flashing and heavy sill anchors. When extra door anchors come up, the engine folds them into the existing concrete-anchor line rather than making a separate row.
- Labor is one combined line built from crew hours, not a flat per-foot charge. It adds up: a one-time mobilization (load, drive, stage, default 2 hours), per-opening setup time for every window and door (default 45 minutes each), window install time (footage times a minutes-per-foot rate), door install time, and a second inspection-day return trip when sliding or bifold doors need one. Those total hours are multiplied by what the crew costs you per hour (crew size times each person's pay, default 2 people at $30/hour).
- The window install minutes-per-foot starts from a base that depends on the job: about 10 minutes per foot on stick-frame new construction, 25 on block, 40 on a remodel. That base is then bumped up for height (times 1.3 for 2-story, times 1.65 for 3-story) and for impact product (times 1.15).
- Next it handles material sales tax. The tax rate (default 0 until you set it) is applied only to physical materials and door materials, never to labor or pass-through fees like permits, disposal, and lift. Rather than showing tax as its own customer-facing line, it bakes the tax into each material's cost so you see true landed cost. (In Florida you don't charge customers tax on the install labor itself.)
- It sums everything into your total cost. Then it applies your profit margin (default 35%) on top to get the selling price, and the difference between selling price and cost is your profit.
- Finally it converts costs into a per-foot figure by dividing each cost by the window footage, so you get a clean dollars-per-linear-foot number for the quote.

- Every time you touch an input, the whole calculation reruns and the screen updates: the breakdown table, the per-foot footer, the grand total, the selling price, the profit, the labor-hours detail card, and the shopping list of materials with pack/case counts.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls its inputs from the job rail you fill in on the left: window footage, window count, house type, construction type, install application, stories, impact-or-not, and any doors you've added.
- Reads your saved prices and rules from Settings: every material's unit price and brand variant, crew size and pay, the per-opening and mobilization times, the impact multiplier, the materials tax rate, and your default margin. Change a rate in Settings and the quote reflects it immediately.
- Hands its door math off to the dedicated door calculators (swing, sliding, bifold), which return the counts, footage, flashing, and anchor extras the engine then folds in.
- Uses the AI cut-list result for wood bucking when one exists, so the buck board footage on the quote matches the exact cut list.
- Feeds the on-screen results: the cost breakdown table, the per-LF and grand-total footers, the selling price / total cost / profit tiles, the labor-hours detail card, and the Materials Needed shopping list with pack and case counts.
- Its output is what gets saved to a job and what flows into the customer-facing documents (the quote PDF, the dashboard pipeline figures, and the e-sign packet). The window footage it preserves is the single number reused across saving, the quote, and the dashboard.
- Connects to the manufacturer database for the through-frame anchor and screw-density rates that change per window brand and impact rating.

### Good numbers to know

- Default profit margin: 35% added on top of your total cost to set the selling price.
- Material sales tax: starts at 0% until you set your local rate; applies only to materials and door materials, never to labor, permit, disposal, or lift.
- Block sealer: 5 gallons per 300 linear feet, always rounded up to the next full 5-gallon bucket.
- Crew defaults: 2 people at $30/hour each = $60/hour crew cost; 45 minutes of setup per opening (each window and each door); 2 hours one-time mobilization per job.
- Window install base speed: about 10 min/ft on stick-frame new construction, 25 min/ft on block, 40 min/ft on a remodel.
- Install-time multipliers stack on the base speed: 2-story times 1.3, 3-story times 1.65, impact product times 1.15.
- Lift rental: 2-plus-story jobs only, charged per day, with one extra day auto-added when a sliding or bifold door requires an inspection wait.
- Disposal: charged per window on remodels only; permit and lift are optional toggles you turn on.
- Door frame footage (sliding and bifold) is added to material quantities only, never to the saved window footage; door labor is counted by panels/units, not by the foot.
- The per-foot figures on the quote are always computed against the window footage only.

## 2. Labor Model

*The Labor Model figures out how many crew-hours a job will really take, then turns those hours into a dollar cost based on what you pay your crew. Instead of charging labor by the foot (which shortchanges you on lots of small windows and overcharges on a few big ones), it adds up the real time buckets of a jobsite day: loading and driving, setting up at each opening, and the actual install. That single labor cost then flows into the quote and gets your profit margin added on top, just like any material.*

### How it works

- It starts the clock with mobilization: one flat block of 2 hours per job for loading the truck, driving, and staging. This is added once, no matter how big the job, as long as there's at least one opening or some footage to install.
- Next it adds per-opening setup time: 45 minutes for EVERY opening on the job. An opening is any window, swing door, sliding glass door, or bifold. It counts them all up and multiplies by 45 minutes. This is the part that protects you on small-window jobs (more openings = more setups).
- Then it adds the window install time, based on total feet of window. The base speed depends on the kind of work: about 10 minutes per foot for new stick-frame construction, about 25 minutes per foot on block-framed homes, and about 40 minutes per foot on remodels. It picks the slowest-applicable rate (remodel beats block, block beats new).
- It then stretches that window install time for hard-to-reach and tougher work. Two-story work multiplies the install time by 1.3; three-story by 1.65. Impact (hurricane) windows multiply it by another 1.15. These only apply to the window install portion, not the setup or driving time.
- It adds door install time on top: swing doors by the minutes you've set per door, and sliding-glass and bifold doors by panels times hours-per-panel (about 4 hours per sliding panel, 5 hours per bifold panel), with the impact bump applied to those too.
- If the job has sliding or bifold doors, it adds one inspection return trip - a second drive-out on a later day to set the heavy panels and snap covers after the county's screw inspection. If a job has both, it only charges for ONE return trip (the larger of the two), not two.
- It sums all those buckets into one total crew-hours number.
- Finally it turns hours into dollars: total crew-hours times your crew cost per hour. Crew cost per hour is your crew size times what you pay each person per hour (out of the box, 2 people times $30 each = $60/hour). The result is one labor cost figure.
- That one labor cost is treated as a plain cost in the quote - it gets your job profit margin added on top, the same as materials. There is no separate 'bill rate'; your markup is where the labor profit comes from.
- The on-screen Labor Detail card shows the same hours and crew cost so the quote and the detail card always match, and it lists each bucket (mobilization, setup, window install, door install, inspection trip) as its own line.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls the opening counts from the rest of the quote: how many windows you entered, plus swing doors, sliding glass doors, and bifolds from their sections - each one triggers a 45-minute setup.
- Pulls total window footage and the install speed from the same job settings that drive the rest of the pricing (construction type, house type), so the labor rate tracks whatever job you're quoting.
- Reads your job's stories (1/2/3) and whether it's impact, and applies the same height and impact multipliers used elsewhere so labor scales with difficulty.

- Gets door install times from the swing-door, sliding-door, and bifold sections - the same per-door and per-panel numbers used to price those doors.
- Sends its single labor cost into the main quote calculation as one line, where the job's profit margin is applied to it along with everything else.
- Feeds the Labor Detail card on the quote screen, the crew-hours shown in the job scope summary, and (optionally) a labor-hours section in the customer PDF, which is OFF by default.
- All the dials - 45-min setup, 2-hr mobilization, crew size, and pay per person - live in Settings under the Labor Model panel, so you can match them to your real crew.

### Good numbers to know

- Mobilization: 2 hours flat per job (load, drive, stage), added once.
- Per-opening setup: 45 minutes for every opening (each window AND each door of any type).
- Window install base speed: ~10 min/ft new construction, ~25 min/ft block-framed, ~40 min/ft remodel (uses the slowest that applies).
- Height multiplier on install: 2-story x1.3, 3-story x1.65 (1-story is no change).
- Impact (hurricane) multiplier on install: x1.15.
- Door install: swing doors by your set minutes per door; sliding glass ~4 hours per panel; bifold ~5 hours per panel (impact bump applies).
- Inspection return trip: charged once if there are sliding or bifold doors - if both, only the larger single trip, never both.
- Crew cost default: 2 people x $30/hour each = $60/hour. Labor cost = total crew-hours x crew cost per hour.
- Labor is a cost that gets the job's profit margin added on top - there is no separate customer bill rate.
- Customer PDF labor-hours section is OFF by default.

# 3. Sliding Glass & Bifold Doors

*This part lets you price big glass openings — sliding glass doors and bifold (folding) glass walls — separately from regular windows, because they take far more labor and a few special materials. You tell Anchor how many panels, how wide and tall, and how many of each; it works out the extra crew hours, the special sill flashing and heavy anchors, and an inspection return trip, then folds all of that into the same quote total as everything else. It keeps these doors in their own bucket so their footage never gets mistakenly counted as window footage.*

## How it works

- Each door is described three ways: number of panels, the overall width and height in inches, and how many of that exact door. Sliding doors allow 2 to 8 panels (defaults to 3 if blank); bifolds allow 2 to 10 panels (defaults to 3).
- If you leave the width blank, Anchor estimates it by multiplying the panel count by a default panel width — 36 inches per panel for sliding doors, 32 inches per leaf for bifolds. So a blank 4-panel slider is treated as 144 inches wide.
- If you leave the height blank, it uses a default tall size — 80 inches for sliding doors, 96 inches for bifolds (folding walls tend to run tall).
- It figures two footage numbers for each door. The full frame perimeter (twice the width plus twice the height, all converted to feet) and a separate sill run equal to just the width in feet.
- Labor is driven by panels, not footage: it counts up every panel across all the doors, then charges crew hours per panel — 4 hours per sliding panel, 5 hours per bifold leaf (bifolds are more because each leaf is hinged, leveled and aligned). A 3-panel slider is 12 hours.
- Those panel hours are then bumped up by the job's impact (hurricane glass) labor factor, the same multiplier used elsewhere, so impact doors cost more labor automatically.
- Special materials are added on top: a sill/track flashing charge based on the door's width in feet ($4.50 per foot for sliders, $5.00 per foot for bifolds), plus heavy-duty anchors — 4 extra anchors per panel — priced at the job's concrete anchor rate.
- If the job has any sliding or bifold doors, it adds one inspection return trip — a second visit (2 crew hours) to set the panels and snap covers after the building department inspects the screws.
- It is smart about not double-charging: if a job has both sliding AND bifold doors, the crew only returns once, so it uses the larger return-trip time, not the sum. Same idea for the lift — only one extra lift-rental day is added for the inspection wait, even if both door types are present.
- Everything rolls up into the normal quote: the panel hours join the single unified labor line, and the flashing and anchors join the material costs, so the door work shows up in the same total, margin and breakdown as the rest of the job.
- When a plan is read by the AI, sliding and bifold doors are split out into their own lists automatically; if the AI gives a width but no panel count, it estimates panels by dividing the width by the default panel width and rounding.

## How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls the impact (hurricane) labor multiplier and the per-foot install rate from the same labor model the windows use, so door labor reflects stories and glass type without separate setup.
- Feeds the shared per-foot material engine: the door frame perimeter footage is added to the window footage only when figuring quantities of screws, caulk, shims and bucking — never added to the window linear-foot total you typed, which prevents footage from being saved as windows and snowballing on every reload.

- Each door counts as an opening, so it adds to the per-opening setup time (measure, level, plumb, anchor, cleanup) right alongside windows and swing doors.
- Borrows the concrete-anchor unit price from the cost item list to price the extra heavy anchors.
- Adds an extra day to the lift rental when a lift is already on a 2-plus-story job, to cover the inspection wait.
- Gets auto-filled by the AI plan reader, which separates sliders and bifolds into their own buckets and also feeds all openings into the wood buck cut list.
- Shows up on the quote PDF, the cost breakdown, the saved job file, and the dashboard counts as its own labeled line with door count and total panels.
- All the rates and defaults (hours per panel, flashing per foot, anchors per panel, default panel sizes, inspection return trip, on/off switch) are editable in Settings under Rates.

## Good numbers to know

- Sliding doors: 2 to 8 panels, default panel width 36 in, default height 80 in, 4 crew-hours per panel, sill flashing $4.50 per foot of width.
- Bifold doors: 2 to 10 panels (default 3), default leaf width 32 in, default height 96 in, 5 crew-hours per leaf, sill flashing $5.00 per foot of width.
- Heavy anchors: 4 extra per panel for both door types, priced at the concrete-anchor rate.
- Inspection return trip: one per job that has any of these doors, 2 crew-hours; sliders and bifolds share the single trip (larger of the two, not added together).
- Lift: one extra rental day for the inspection wait on 2-plus-story jobs, shared across both door types.
- Blank width is filled as panel count times the default panel width; blank height uses the default height.
- Panel hours are multiplied by the job's impact labor factor, the same one used for windows.
- Door frame footage feeds material quantities only — it is never added to the window linear-foot total.
- Either door type can be switched off entirely in Settings, which hides its editor and zeroes its costs.

# 4. Buck Cut List

*The Buck Cut List turns a window/door schedule into a yard order and a cut sheet for the pressure-treated lumber that frames out (bucks) every opening on a block job. You feed it the openings, and it figures out exactly how many boards of which lengths to buy, how to cut them with the least waste, and what that lumber costs on the quote. It saves you from doing the takeoff math by hand and from over-buying wood.*

### How it works

- First it gets a list of openings. Either the AI reads your uploaded plan and pulls out every opening, or you paste in a list. Each opening has a room/location, a width, a height, a quantity, and a type (window, sliding glass door, or bifold door).
- It needs the MASONRY OPENING — the block hole the buck boards frame — which is NOT the window size and NOT the rough opening. The buck boards always eat 3 inches per dimension (two 1.5-inch jambs across the width; a 1.5-inch head and sill across the height), and the finished hole has to end up the window plus a 1/2-inch shim. So the app converts whatever the schedule gave: a labeled Masonry Opening (M.O.) is used as-is; a labeled Rough Opening (R.O., already the window + 1/4-inch shim each side) gets 3 inches added; a plain nominal/unit/glass size gets 3.5 inches added. All three land on the same masonry opening (a 36 x 60 window → 39.5 x 63.5). Right in the cut-list window you can confirm or override the size type for each opening, and set the default for any the schedule doesn't label. Stick-framed openings use the R.O. as-is and need no buck at all.
- It breaks each opening into the actual boards you'd cut. A window becomes 4 pieces: a head, a sill, and two side jambs. A sliding glass door or bifold door gets NO sill — just a head and two jambs (3 pieces), because the floor is the threshold.
- It sizes each piece the way a framer actually builds it. The head and sill are cut to the EXACT opening width — they span the full opening, top and bottom (a head can not be wider than the hole it sits in). The jambs are cut shorter so they tuck between them and the head rests on top: a window jamb is 3 inches shorter than the opening height (it meets both the head and the sill, 1.5 inches each), and a door jamb is 1.5 inches shorter (it only meets the head).
- If any single piece is longer than the longest board available (16 ft), it splices it into multiple parts so it can still be ordered.
- Then it packs the cuts onto boards to waste as little wood as possible. It works from the longest piece down, and drops each piece onto the board where it leaves the tightest leftover — fewest scrap inches. It also accounts for an eighth-inch of wood lost to the saw blade on every cut.
- After the first pass it tries to empty out boards: it takes the least-loaded board and tries to redistribute its cuts into the slack on the other boards. If everything fits, that board disappears and you buy one fewer. It keeps doing this until nothing more can be combined.
- Then it shrinks each board down to the smallest stock length that still holds its cuts. Available lengths are 16, 12, 10, and 8 feet, so a board only holding short cuts gets ordered as a shorter, cheaper length.
- It does one cleanup on the order: if only one or two boards ended up on some short length (a straggler run) and you're already buying 16-footers, it bumps those up to 16 ft so the lumberyard order stays one clean length. A real run of short boards is left alone.
- Finally it tallies everything: total boards, the order broken out by length (e.g. so many 16-footers, so many 12s), total linear feet of 2x6, total pieces, and an overall waste percentage.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Gets its openings from the same plan-reading step the rest of the quote uses. When the AI reads a plan, windows feed the window count and linear footage, sliding glass doors and bifold doors split off into their own buckets, and ALL openings (windows + both door types) feed the buck list so every frame gets bucked.
- Pricing the lumber feeds straight into the quote's Wood Bucking line. When a cut list exists, that line is priced off the cut list's actual linear feet of 2x6 (at the 2x6 PT lumber price) instead of the usual rough per-foot estimate — the line is labeled 'AI cut list' so you know it came from the real takeoff.
- Only applies on block-framed jobs. Bucking is a block-frame thing, so generating a cut list automatically switches the job to Block Framed, and the Wood Bucking line only prices when the job is Block Framed.
- If there's no cut list, the Wood Bucking line falls back to the standard per-linear-foot estimate, and the Materials list flags that the bucking is estimated rather than from a real takeoff.
- The finished cut list shows up as a downloadable PDF in Job Files (yard order + cut sheet), so the crew has a cut sheet on the floor and you have a clean order for the yard.

## Good numbers to know

- Masonry opening = the buck size. From a nominal/unit size add 3.5 inches (W and H); from a labeled R.O. add 3 inches; a labeled M.O. is used as-is. Example: a 36 x 60 window → 39.5 x 63.5 masonry opening, which leaves a 36.5 x 60.5 hole (the window + a 1/2-inch shim).
- Windows = 4 pieces (head, sill, 2 jambs). Sliding glass doors and bifold doors = 3 pieces (head + 2 jambs, no sill).
- Head and sill are cut to the exact opening width (they span the full opening; the head rests on top of the jambs).
- Jambs are cut shorter: 3 inches shorter than opening height on a window, 1.5 inches shorter on a door.
- Lumber is 2x6 pressure-treated; default material cost is $0.95 per linear foot.
- Available board lengths: 16, 12, 10, and 8 feet. Anything longer than 16 ft gets spliced.
- An eighth of an inch (1/8") of wood is lost to the saw on every cut.
- Straggler cleanup: if only 1 or 2 boards land on a short length and 16-footers are already being ordered, those get bumped to 16 ft to keep one clean length.
- The base Wood Bucking estimate rate (used only when there's no cut list) is $1.25 per linear foot on block-framed jobs.

# 5. AI Plan / Schedule Reading

*This is the feature that lets you upload a window schedule (a PDF or photo) and have the app read it for you, instead of typing every opening in by hand. It looks at the drawing the way a person would, pulls out every window and door, figures out the rough openings and totals, and drops all of that straight into your calculator. The goal is to save you the tedious takeoff and get a job mostly filled in within about a minute.*

### How it works

- You upload one or more files (a PDF schedule, or PNG/JPEG photos of the sheets). You must be signed in to use it.
- The app turns every page into a picture first. Even for a PDF, it renders each page as an image, because the AI reads the drawing visually (looking at the table) rather than just scraping hidden text. It reads up to 20 pages in one batch, and won't send files that add up to more than 30 MB.
- Those page images get sent to the AI with a detailed instruction sheet telling it exactly what to look for and what format to answer in.
- First the AI hunts for the manufacturer (Viwinco, Pella, Andersen, PGT, etc.) in the title block, header row, notes, or any manufacturer column, and the project or job name (homeowner or street address). If it can't find either, it says Unknown.
- Then it goes row by row through the schedule. The most important rule it's told: ALWAYS read the quantity column (QTY, COUNT, NO., #). One row often means several identical units, so a 'W1' row with a qty of 4 counts as four windows, not one. It only assumes 1 when no quantity is shown anywhere.
- For each opening it reads the width and height EXACTLY as the schedule prints them (3'-0" becomes 36, 36 1/2" becomes 36.5) and tags WHICH size it is — a rough opening (R.O.), a masonry opening (M.O.), or a plain nominal/unit size — so the buck tool can size the lumber correctly. It does not inflate the number itself.
- The app — not the AI — turns that tagged size into the masonry opening the buck frames: a nominal/unit size gets 3.5 inches added, a rough opening gets 3 inches added, and a masonry opening is used as-is. So a plain 36 x 60 unit and a 36.5 x 60.5 R.O. both land on the same 39.5 x 63.5 masonry opening. You can override the tag per opening in the cut-list window.
- It sorts every opening into one of three buckets: a regular window, a sliding glass door (slider, SGD, patio door, codes like XO/XOX), or a bifold door (folding glass wall, accordion). Sliders and bifolds are flagged separately because they're more involved and shouldn't be priced as plain windows.
- For sliders and bifolds it also counts panels — a code like XOX means 3, XOXO means 4, otherwise it reads the stated leaf count or estimates from the width — and reports the overall opening size, not a single panel size.
- It also scans for Florida product approval numbers (FL#) and Miami-Dade NOA numbers anywhere on the sheet or in the notes, along with what each one applies to.
- Once the AI answers, the app does the math itself rather than trusting the AI's totals. It adds up the window count from the quantities, calculates linear feet as the perimeter of each window (twice the width plus twice the height) times its quantity, totals that, and divides by 12 to get linear feet rounded to one decimal.
- It then fills your calculator: window count, total linear feet, manufacturer (matched to your dropdown list), and the job name (only if you haven't already typed one — it never overwrites your name). Sliding doors and bifolds go into their own sections, and the Florida approvals show up in their own card you can tap to look up.
- Every field the AI filled gets a gold 'AI' badge so you know to double-check it. The badge disappears the moment you edit that field, so badges only ever mark values you haven't reviewed yet.

- If a page is unreadable or the AI finds nothing usable, it tells you to try a clearer page or just the schedule sheet — and that failed read does NOT count against your monthly allowance.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Feeds the main calculator directly: it sets the window count, total linear feet, and manufacturer the same way you would by hand, so all your pricing and cost breakdowns flow from there.
- Builds the buck cut list automatically from every opening it reads (windows plus sliders plus bifolds), so the same upload that fills your quote also gives you a lumber cut list and board count.
- Loads sliding glass doors and bifold doors into their own rail sections (with panels and sizes), where they're counted and priced separately from windows.
- Populates the Florida Product Approvals card — each approval number it found becomes a tappable row that jumps straight into the FL approval lookup, pre-searched for that number.
- Fills the job name field from the plan's title block, but only when the field is empty, so it never clobbers something you typed.
- There's also a manual fallback: a one-click button copies a ready-made prompt and opens Grok in a new tab, so you can paste the schedule yourself and then paste the reply back in — it runs through the exact same math and fill-in logic.
- Your subscription plan controls how many automatic reads you get per billing cycle, and each read is checked and counted before the AI is called.

### Good numbers to know

- Masonry opening from the schedule size: nominal/unit +3.5" (W and H), labeled R.O. +3", labeled M.O. as-is. A stick-framed opening uses the R.O. as-is and needs no buck.
- Linear feet per window = (2 x width) + (2 x height), in inches, times the quantity; all of it summed and divided by 12, rounded to one decimal.
- Quantity rule: always read the QTY column; one row can mean several units. Only assume 1 if no quantity is shown anywhere.
- Three opening types: window, sliding glass door, bifold door. Only sliders and bifolds carry a panel count.
- Panel codes: XO/OX = 2 panels, XOX/OXO = 3, XOXO = 4, and so on.
- Reads up to 20 pages per upload; total upload size capped at 30 MB.
- Monthly AI plan-read allowance by plan: 5 on the free trial, 2 on Starter, 100 on Pro, unlimited on the top tier. A read that finds nothing is refunded and doesn't count.
- You must be signed in to use AI plan reading.
- Feet/inches and fractions are converted to plain inches: 3'-0" becomes 36, 36 1/2" becomes 36.5.
- Every AI-filled field shows a gold 'AI' badge as a reminder to double-check; it clears as soon as you edit that field.

# 6. Florida Building-Code Lookup

*This is Anchor's built-in lookup for Florida product approvals (FL numbers) and their official installation drawings. Type a manufacturer, a series name, or an FL number, and it searches a database of 3,436 active window and exterior-door approvals pulled from the state's floridabuilding.org site, then shows you the impact/HVHZ ratings, design-pressure numbers, and a tap-to-open viewer for the actual installation PDF (the one with the screw spacing and embedment specs). It saves you from leaving the app to hunt down approval paperwork while you're putting together a quote or prepping for permitting and inspection.*

## How it works

- The whole approval database loads quietly in the background the first time you open the lookup, so by the time you type, results feel instant. It comes down as one compressed file (about 800 KB) that's kept in memory for the rest of your session, so it only downloads once.
- It always tries the smaller compressed copy first and unzips it on the fly; if your browser can't do that, it quietly grabs the full uncompressed copy instead. If both fail, it shows a 'Couldn't load' message with a Retry button.
- When you type, it figures out what kind of search you mean. It recognizes FL numbers in any form you'd naturally type them, like 'FL57', 'fl 57', plain '57', or a number with a revision such as 'FL57-R20', and treats all of those the same.
- It ranks matches so the most relevant rise to the top: an exact FL-number match comes first, then a manufacturer-name match, then anything where your text appears somewhere in the record. It needs at least 2 characters before it searches, and it shows up to 100 results (50 on the public landing-page version), nudging you to refine if you hit the limit.
- Each result card reads the product variants inside that approval and auto-labels them: Impact or Non-Impact, an HVHZ tag if any variant is high-velocity-hurricane-zone rated, and the design-pressure rating. It lists up to 6 model lines per card and notes how many more exist beyond that.
- For approvals the team has already hand-extracted, the card shows a clean Screw Pattern block (fastener type, spacing from corners, max spacing along the run, and minimum embedment) broken out by substrate. For everything else, it falls back to letting you open the original drawing.
- The 'View install drawing' section stays collapsed until you click it, so cards render fast and it only pulls a PDF's worth of data for the drawings you actually open. Once opened, it's remembered so re-opening is instant.
- Because the state's website blocks PDFs from being shown directly inside another app, Anchor routes each PDF through its own pass-through service, which fetches the file and hands it back so it can display inline. There's also an 'Open in new tab' link and a link to the full record on floridabuilding.org.
- The pass-through service is locked down on purpose: it only accepts PDF addresses from floridabuilding.org's official upload folder, refuses to follow any redirect that would bounce it elsewhere, gives up after 60 seconds, and caches each PDF for a day so repeat views are quick.
- Your own saved approvals show at the top, and the official state database results show below them, so your curated favorites and the full catalog live in one place.

## How it connects to the rest of the app

- Ties into the Read Plan feature: when the AI reads an uploaded window schedule, it pulls any Florida approval / Miami-Dade NOA numbers off the plans into a 'Florida Product Approvals' card on the job.
- Each approval number on that job card is tappable, and tapping it opens this lookup already searched for that number, so you go straight from the plan to the matching state record and its drawing.

- Shares its install-drawing viewer with your saved/seeded approvals: any FL number in your reference list that matches a record in the state database gets the same inline PDF viewer, resolved automatically by FL number (preferring the exact revision, otherwise any revision that has a drawing on file).
- The same search and result cards power both the in-app lookup and the public landing-page search, so they behave identically.
- The approval data is published alongside the app itself and refreshed by the team, so updates require no separate upload step on your end.
- Note: this is reference material, not a substitute for verification. The app reminds you to confirm the exact FL number on the unit's NFRC label and download the latest PDF from floridabuilding.org before relying on it, and to make sure the pattern matches the installed product's size, DP rating, and substrate.

## Good numbers to know

- Database covers 3,436 active Florida approvals for windows and exterior doors.
- Loads once per session as a roughly 800 KB compressed file, then stays in memory.
- Needs at least 2 typed characters before it searches.
- Shows up to 100 results in the app (50 on the public landing-page version).
- Each card lists up to 6 model lines, with a count of any extras.
- Search ranking order: exact FL-number match, then manufacturer-name match, then any partial text match.
- The PDF viewer opens about 600 pixels tall and is loaded only when you expand it.
- The PDF pass-through only allows files from floridabuilding.org's official upload folder, refuses redirects, times out at 60 seconds, and caches each file for 1 day.
- Recognizes FL numbers typed any way: 'FL57', 'fl 57', '57', or with a revision like 'FL57-R20'.
- When matching a saved approval to a drawing, it prefers the exact revision but will use any revision of that FL number that has a PDF.

# 7. Dashboard / Job Pipeline

*The Dashboard is your home base after you sign in: it's a single screen that shows every quote you've saved, where each deal stands, and a running tally of your money. It pulls the numbers straight from your saved jobs, sorts them into stages from cold lead to won, and tells you your win rate, your average margin, and which materials are eating your money the most, so you can see your whole business at a glance instead of digging through individual quotes.*

### How it works

- It starts with your saved jobs. Every time you finish a quote and hit Save, that job gets stored, and the Dashboard reads that list to build everything you see.
- It ignores working drafts. A half-finished quote you haven't formally saved is treated as a 'draft' and is left out of all the pipeline math and money totals, so your numbers only reflect real, finished quotes.
- Every job carries a deal stage: Lead, Quoted, Approved, Won, or Lost. If a job somehow has no stage set, it's treated as Quoted by default.
- It sorts all your real jobs into those five stage buckets, then adds up the dollar value (the selling price you quoted) and the count of jobs in each bucket.
- The four big tiles up top are the summary. Open pipeline = the total dollars and number of deals still in play (everything in Lead plus Quoted). Won = total dollars and count of jobs you've landed. Win rate = of the deals that have been decided (Won plus Lost), the percent you won; if nothing's been decided yet it shows a dash. Avg margin = the average profit margin across all your saved jobs.
- Below the tiles is the funnel: one button per stage showing how many jobs and how many dollars sit there. Tapping a stage filters your job list to just that stage; tapping it again clears the filter.
- The 'Where your materials go' section adds up the materials used across every saved job, ranks them by total dollars spent, and flags your single biggest cost driver as a percentage of total spend. It also shows average quantity per job and cost per linear foot, with a pie, bar, or trend chart.
- The job cards at the bottom are your individual quotes, newest first. Each card shows the customer, the manufacturer and footage, the selling price, the margin, a stage dropdown you can change on the spot, and a photo thumbnail.
- The Approved stage can update itself: when a customer e-signs a quote you sent, the system automatically flips that job to Approved and pops a notification, even while you're looking at the Dashboard.
- The search box filters cards by customer name, address, or manufacturer as you type. The status dropdown on any card lets you move a deal to a new stage instantly, and that change saves and syncs right away.
- Changing a stage, adding a photo, deleting a job, or editing customer details all save immediately and quietly sync to the cloud so the same picture shows up on your other devices.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls every number from your saved quotes. The selling price, cost, margin, footage, manufacturer, window and door counts, and material list shown here all come straight from what the calculator produced when you saved each job.
- Feeds the calculator back. Hitting 'Load' on a card drops that whole quote back into the calculator so you can tweak it or re-quote; the changes flow back to the Dashboard when you save again.
- Connects to the e-signature feature. When a quote you sent gets signed by the customer, that job is automatically marked Approved here, and a separate E-signatures panel on the same screen tracks which quotes are sent, viewed, or signed.

- Hands off to document exports. From a job's detail view you can generate that quote's customer proposal, cost breakdown, materials list, or buck cut list without leaving the Dashboard.
- Spits out a CSV. 'Export CSV' writes one row per saved job (customer, stage, contact info, specs, cost, price, margin, profit, date) so you can open your whole pipeline in Excel or Google Sheets.
- Syncs to the cloud. Saved jobs and any change you make (stage, photo, notes, delete) quietly push to your account so the Dashboard looks the same on every device you sign in on; drafts stay only on the device you made them.
- Is the launch pad for the rest of the app: buttons here jump you to a new quote, the Florida code lookup, your settings and rates, and pricing.

### Good numbers to know

- Five deal stages, in order: Lead, Quoted, Approved, Won, Lost.
- Default stage for any job missing one: Quoted.
- Open pipeline = Lead + Quoted (dollars and deal count).
- Win rate = Won divided by (Won + Lost); shows a dash until at least one deal is decided.
- Avg margin = the average margin percent across all saved jobs.
- Drafts (unsaved working quotes) are excluded from every total, the funnel, and the CSV.
- Approved is set automatically when a customer e-signs a quote you sent.
- Job photos: uploaded photos are auto-shrunk (max 640px wide) and branded with a light blur and the job title; max upload size about 12MB.
- The materials section ranks every material by total dollars spent and calls out your single biggest cost driver as a percent of total spend.
- CSV export covers only saved (non-draft) jobs, one row each, filename dated to the day you export.

# 8. Generated Documents & Viewer

*This is the part of Anchor that turns a job you've built into clean, professional PDFs — the customer's quote, your internal cost breakdown, a shopping list for the supply run, and a board-by-board buck cut list. You can preview any of these right inside the app, download them, or share them straight to text/email, all without leaving the screen. Every document is built fresh on the spot from the current job's numbers, so it always reflects exactly what you have on the screen at that moment.*

### How it works

- Anchor offers four documents per job: the Customer Quote (the polished price sheet you hand a homeowner), the Cost Breakdown (your private numbers — costs, margin, profit), the Materials List (a check-off shopping list with no prices to scare anyone), and the Buck Cut List (every board to buy and where each cut goes).
- Before it builds anything, it re-runs the job's math from scratch so the document can never be stale or out of sync with what you're looking at.
- It then checks you've actually entered something to quote — there has to be linear footage, or at least one swing door, sliding glass door, or bifold door. If there's nothing, it stops and tells you to enter footage or doors first.
- Next it makes sure the job is SAVED. Customer-facing documents only generate for a saved job — if you haven't saved, it nudges you to save first. (Once a job is saved, you can re-make its documents as many times as you want for free; the owner/admin account skips this check.)
- For the Customer Quote, it does one more safety check: if you're still running the demo company name 'Prime Window & Door' or haven't finished setup, it warns you before letting a quote go out with placeholder branding — so a real homeowner never gets a quote with someone else's name on it.
- It then lays out the page: your logo (or your company name in big type if no logo), a thin gold accent line, your tagline, the date, and an auto-generated quote number based on the time it was made.
- The Customer Quote prints a 'Prepared For' block with the customer's name and address, a 'Scope of Work' list (manufacturer, application, house type, construction, glass type, stories, linear footage, window count, any swing/sliding/bifold doors, permit, and lift), then the big total price front and center with 'Labor and materials included' under it, and standard terms.
- If the job has sliding glass doors or bifold doors, the quote automatically notes a one-day inspection (a return trip to check screws before the panels go in), unless you've turned that off in settings.
- The Cost Breakdown is the same job but for your eyes only: a full table of every line item with rate per linear foot, quantity, how many cases/packs that works out to, and the line total, then a summary with total job cost, your margin percent, projected profit, and the selling price. It's stamped 'Internal cost breakdown — not for customer distribution.'
- The Materials List converts every line item into how many packs/cases/boards to actually buy, with a checkbox beside each so the person doing the supply run can tick items off at the counter. It shows an estimated materials total (just the rough material spend — no labor, no margin) and deliberately hides the per-item prices.
- If the job uses wood bucking but you haven't generated a real cut list yet, the Materials List warns you that the boards shown are just a rough estimate and pushes you to generate the Buck Cut List for exact lengths and counts.
- The Buck Cut List prints the yard order (how many boards of what length to buy), the waste percentage, and then goes board by board: each board, its stock length, and every cut to make from it — with the opening, room, and a color-coded label (red for Head, blue for Sill, green for Jamb) and a checkbox so the crew can mark each cut as it's made.

- When you choose View, it doesn't pop open a new browser tab (which phones often block). Instead it loads a PDF rendering engine and draws each page right inside an in-app preview window, sized to look crisp on both desktop and phone. If that engine can't load for any reason, it falls back to just downloading the file so the button always does something.
- From the preview window you can still Download or Share the exact document you're looking at — it reuses the already-built file rather than rebuilding it.
- The Share button uses your device's native share sheet to send the PDF as a real file attachment to text, email, etc. It only appears on devices that support file sharing (mostly phones/tablets); on most desktops, Share quietly downloads the file instead. As a privacy rule, sharing never passes along any dollar amounts to the app's usage tracking.
- Every document is reachable two ways: from the job you're actively working on (a little icon menu with View / Download / Share, plus 'Copy signing link' on the Customer Quote), and from the dashboard for any saved job — where it briefly swaps in that job's saved numbers, builds the document, then restores whatever you were working on so your current screen isn't disturbed.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls all its numbers from the job calculator — the same engine that powers the on-screen totals — so the printed documents always match what you see in the app.
- Uses your Profile/Branding setup for the logo, company name, tagline, city/state, phone, email, and website that appear in the header and footer of every document.
- Requires the job to be saved first (the Save Job flow) before customer documents will generate — saving is the single point where a quote 'counts,' and re-printing afterward is free.
- Reads your Settings for optional touches: whether to show estimated crew-hours on the customer quote, and whether sliding/bifold doors add the one-day inspection note.
- The Buck Cut List is driven by the buck/cut-list tool — if you've run it, the Materials List also uses those exact board lengths and counts instead of a rough estimate.
- Ties into e-signatures: the Customer Quote has a 'Copy signing link' action so you can send it for electronic signing, and once a customer signs, a separate signed/countersigned PDF is produced with the signature, timestamp, and a legal e-sign reference.
- Feeds the dashboard, which lets you generate any of these documents for any past job without leaving the dashboard view.
- Logs lightweight, dollar-free usage events (e.g. 'customer quote made,' 'previewed,' 'shared') for the app's analytics, never including prices.

### Good numbers to know

- Four documents per job: Customer Quote, Cost Breakdown (internal), Materials List, and Buck Cut List.
- Three actions per document: View (in-app preview), Download, and Share — plus 'Copy signing link' on the Customer Quote.
- A quote won't generate unless there's linear footage OR at least one swing, sliding, or bifold door entered.
- Customer documents require the job to be SAVED first; after saving, re-printing is unlimited and free. The owner/admin account is exempt from this gate.
- Customer Quote is valid for 30 days, and pricing is noted as subject to change if scope changes on inspection.
- Sliding glass doors and bifold doors automatically add a +1 day inspection note (a return trip for screw inspection before panels), unless turned off in settings.
- Cost Breakdown shows margin percent, projected profit, and selling price, and is labeled 'not for customer distribution.'

- Materials List shows a rough materials-only total (no labor, no margin) and hides per-item prices, with a checkbox by every item.
- Buck Cut List color key: red = Head, blue = Sill, green = Jamb.
- If a job has wood bucking but no real cut list, both the Materials List and a pop-up warn that the boards are only a rough estimate.
- Customer Quote warns you before printing if you're still on the demo company name 'Prime Window & Door' or haven't finished setup.
- View renders the PDF inside the app (not a new tab, which phones block); if the renderer fails to load, it falls back to a download. Share only shows on devices that support file sharing — desktops download instead.
- Sharing and analytics never include any dollar amounts.

# 9. E-Signatures

*E-Signatures lets you turn a saved quote into a private link you text or email to your customer. They open it on any phone or computer, see a clean branded version of their quote, type their legal name, draw their signature, and tap to approve — no app, no account, no login needed on their end. The moment they sign, the job jumps to "Approved" in your pipeline, you get an instant alert, and you can download a signed PDF certificate for your records.*

## How it works

- When you choose to send a quote for signature, the app freezes a snapshot of that exact job — the price, the scope of work, your logo and contact info, the customer's name, and the date — so what the customer signs can never silently change later, even if you edit the job afterward.
- Before sending, you pick how much detail to show: a simple Summary (just the total and scope) or an Itemized breakdown that groups the selling price into three plain buckets — windows/materials/hardware, professional installation/labor, and permits/inspection fees. It never shows your internal cost or your margin, only the customer's price.
- You can uncheck any scope row or price line you'd rather not show (permits, disposal, lift rental, etc.). If you hide a price line, its dollars get spread across the remaining lines so the parts still add up — the total the customer signs never changes.
- The frozen quote is saved privately under your account and you get back a unique signing link that ends in '/sign/' plus a long random code. That random code is the key: only someone holding the exact link can open the quote, the same idea as a DocuSign link.
- The customer's link does NOT log them in or expose your account. A separate, locked-down door fetches only the customer-safe version of the quote — it strips out anything sensitive before it ever reaches their screen.
- When the customer first opens the link, the quote's status flips from 'Sent' to 'Viewed' so you can see they looked at it (and when).
- To approve, the customer must do three things: type a full legal name (at least 2 characters), draw a signature in the box, and check a consent box agreeing the electronic signature is legally equal to a handwritten one. The Approve button stays greyed out until all three are done.
- When they tap Approve, the app records their typed name, the drawn signature image, the exact time, plus their IP address and device — this is the audit trail. It double-checks the signature really is an image and isn't oversized before accepting it.
- The instant a signature is recorded, the underlying job is flipped to 'Approved' and stamped with who signed and when, so it moves forward in your pipeline automatically.
- If a link expires before it's signed, opening it only shows your brand block (so they know who to ask for a fresh link) and hides the price and customer details. Once a quote IS signed, it stays viewable to the signer as their record.
- Re-signing an already-signed quote does nothing harmful — it just shows the existing signature and date again, so a customer can't accidentally sign twice or overwrite the record.
- While the app is open, a signature that lands pops up an instant celebration alert with the signer's name and total, plus a 'View job' shortcut. If you were away, the app catches up on the next visit and tells you about any quotes signed since you last looked.

## How it connects to the rest of the app

- Pulls its numbers and details straight from a saved job's quote — the same price, scope, and customer info you already built in the calculator, plus your saved brand (logo, company name, phone, email, website).

- Feeds your pipeline dashboard: a signed quote automatically flips the job to 'Approved', the status that sits between 'Quoted' and 'Won' in your funnel.
- Has its own E-Signatures panel on the dashboard listing every quote you've sent, with a status chip (Sent, Viewed, Signed, Declined, Void), a Sent-to-Viewed-to-Signed timeline, and per-quote buttons.
- From that panel you can copy the link again, void a link so it stops working, open the related job, expand the full audit detail (reference id, signer name, IP, device, exact timestamps), or download the signed PDF.
- Produces a countersigned PDF certificate built from the frozen snapshot plus the recorded signature — exactly what the customer saw and agreed to — for your contract records, not re-figured from today's job numbers.
- Deleting a signed record is heavily guarded: it warns you it's a binding agreement, tells you to download the signed PDF first, and makes you type DELETE to confirm, because deleting destroys the signature and audit trail permanently.

### Good numbers to know

- Customer needs nothing to sign — no account, no login, no app install. Just the link.
- Three things are required to approve: a typed legal name (minimum 2 characters), a drawn signature, and a checked consent box.
- The signing link ends in '/sign/' followed by a long random code that acts as the password — anyone with the link can view, so treat it like a private link.
- Two detail levels to send: Summary (total + scope only) or Itemized (three buckets — materials, labor, permits/fees). Internal cost and margin are never shown.
- Hiding a price line spreads its dollars across the others — the signed total never changes.
- Quotes default to valid for 30 days. An expired, unsigned link hides the price and shows only your brand info so the customer knows who to ask for a new one.
- Recorded for every signature: typed name, signature image, exact time, IP address, and device — this is the legal audit trail.
- Signature image is capped at about 600 KB; the whole submission is rejected if it's over roughly 1 MB.
- Signing is one-time and tamper-safe: re-signing just re-shows the existing record; a signed quote can't be voided.
- Deleting a signed record requires typing DELETE and permanently destroys the signature and audit trail.

# 10. Accounts, Setup & Plans Access

*This is the front door of Anchor: how you create an account and sign in, how you fill in your company info and pricing so quotes look like yours, and how the app tracks which plan you're on and how many quotes you have left. It also quietly backs up everything you do to the cloud, so your jobs, brand, and rates follow you to any device you sign in on.*

## How it works

- Signing in: You can create an account with an email and password, log in with that password, sign in with Google, or get a one-time 'magic link' emailed to you. New passwords must be at least 6 characters, and the signup form makes you type the password twice so a typo can't lock you out.
- Forgot password: If you ask for a reset link, the app emails you one. When you click it, you're dropped into a 'set a new password' screen, and the app immediately wipes the secret bits out of the web address so they can't be reused.
- Right after you sign in: The app pulls your saved company profile, pricing, and all your jobs down from the cloud and lands you on your dashboard. If you're offline, it falls back to whatever's stored on this device and shows an 'Offline' note instead of failing.
- First time you ever sign in: If the cloud has nothing for you yet, the app takes whatever you'd already entered on this device and uploads it as your starting point, so nothing you set up before signing in gets lost.
- Setup is optional, not a wall: New users land straight in the calculator with sample (demo) numbers and get gently nudged to finish setup, rather than being forced through a long form before they can do anything.
- Brand setup (your profile): You enter company name, city, state, and county (required), plus optional logo, tagline, phone, email, and website. Each field is checked as you type — a green check when it's good, a red note when it's off (for example, a phone needs at least 10 digits, an email needs an @ and a dot). The Save button stays locked until all four required fields pass.
- No fake company on real quotes: The app ships with a demo company ('Prime Window & Door'). For a brand-new user it treats those demo values as blank so you're forced to type your own. If you try to send a customer quote while the demo name is still showing, it warns you and offers to send you to setup first.
- County drives tax: Picking your county automatically sets a sales-tax estimate for materials, which you can fine-tune later in Settings.
- Pricing setup: A short wizard lets you set your labor rate and your default profit margin (starts at 35%), and optionally enter your manufacturer pricing. Until you finish this, a 'demo pricing in use' banner reminds you the numbers aren't yours yet. Skipping the wizard leaves the demo banner up; completing it clears it.
- Settings is tabbed: One screen with tabs for Brand, Job Defaults, Manufacturers, Rates & Pricing, Subscription, and Account. (Feedback and Admin tabs only appear for the app owner.) A pencil icon next to any cost line on a quote jumps you straight to the exact rate that drives that number and flashes a gold ring around it.
- What plan you're on: Every account starts on a 14-day free trial that allows 8 quotes. Paid plans are Starter ($39/month, 25 quotes), Pro ($99/month, 200 quotes), and Shop ($199/month, unlimited quotes). Annual billing is priced at ten months for a year (about two months free).
- How it decides if you can make another quote: It checks in a fixed order — first, has the free trial run out; next, for paid plans, is the subscription actually active; last, are there quotes left this cycle. If any check fails it shows a friendly upgrade screen instead of letting the quote through.
- What counts as 'using a quote': Saving a job is the single moment a quote is counted against your limit. Building and re-downloading documents for an already-saved job is free and doesn't count again.

- The save-first rule: Customer-facing documents only generate for a saved job. If you try to export without saving, it asks you to save first — this closes the loophole of building a quote, downloading everything, and never having it count.
- Monthly reset: Paid plans automatically reset the quote counter on the monthly anniversary. The trial does not reset on its own — you have to pick a plan to start a fresh cycle.
- Owner exception: The app owner's account has unlimited access, is never blocked, and never burns a quote.
- Upgrading and billing: Picking a plan hands you off to Stripe's secure checkout and brings you right back afterward. A 'Manage Subscription' option opens Stripe's billing portal to change or cancel. The Subscription tab shows your plan, status, days left, and a usage bar that turns yellow near your limit and red at it.
- Everything saves twice: Any change to your profile or rates is written to this device and pushed to the cloud in the background; saving or deleting a job does the same. If a cloud push fails, you still keep the local copy and see a brief 'saved locally' note.
- Signing out: This clears the local copy of your data on this device so the next person who signs in starts clean — your real data is safe in the cloud.

## How it connects to the rest of the app

- Cloud backup is the backbone: The profile, rates, and jobs you set up here are the same data the calculator, dashboard, and document generators read from — setup feeds everything downstream.
- County tax choice in setup flows into the cost breakdown and the materials/sales-tax figures on quotes.
- Labor rate and default margin entered in the setup wizard feed directly into how every quote is priced.
- The plan/quota system gates the act of saving a job, and saving is what the dashboard, PDF quotes, and shared customer links all hang off of.
- The 'save before export' rule connects plans access to the document and sharing features — no saved job, no customer paperwork.
- Upgrade prompts and the Subscription tab hand off to Stripe checkout and the billing portal, and the app updates your plan when you return.
- Signed customer quotes tie back in here: when a customer e-signs, the cloud flips that job's status and the app refreshes your jobs and alerts you, using the same cloud connection that powers account sync.

## Good numbers to know

- Free trial: 14 days, 8 quotes.
- Starter plan: $39/month, 25 quotes per month.
- Pro plan: $99/month, 200 quotes per month (most popular; adds AI plan reading, e-signatures, shareable quote links, photo uploads).
- Shop plan: $199/month, unlimited quotes (adds unlimited AI reads, custom branding on shared quotes, white-glove onboarding).
- Annual billing: priced at 10x the monthly rate (roughly two months free).
- Default profit margin starts at 35%.
- Passwords must be at least 6 characters.
- Required setup fields: company name, city, state, and county. Phone needs 10+ digits; email needs a valid format.
- Paid plans reset the quote counter automatically each month; the trial does not auto-reset — you must subscribe.
- A quote is counted only when you save a job; re-downloading documents for a saved job is free.
- The owner account has unlimited access and never consumes a quote.

# 11. Billing & Subscriptions

*This is the part of Anchor that decides what a contractor is allowed to do based on whether they're on a free trial or a paid plan, counts how many quotes and AI plan-reads they've used this month, and handles the actual subscribing, upgrading, and canceling through Stripe. It's the gatekeeper: it lets paying users keep working, gently nudges trial and capped users to upgrade, and keeps everyone's plan status in sync with what they've actually paid for.*

### How it works

- Every account starts on a free trial: 14 days and 8 quotes, plus a generous taste of 5 AI plan-reads. The clock and the counters start the moment the account is created.
- There are three paid plans, each with a monthly quote allowance and a monthly AI plan-read allowance: Starter is 25 quotes and 2 AI reads, Pro is 200 quotes and 100 AI reads, and Shop is unlimited quotes and unlimited AI reads.
- Every time the contractor goes to create a new quote, the app runs one quick decision in a fixed order before letting it through. First it checks whether a paid month has rolled over and resets the count if so. Then: is this a trial that has run out of days? Then: is this a paid plan whose payment has lapsed? Then: are they out of quotes for the month? If any of those is a yes, it stops and shows a friendly upgrade pop-up instead of making the quote.
- If the check passes, it counts the quote as used (adds one to this month's tally) and lets the work continue. The shop owner's own admin account is the one exception: it never gets blocked and never burns a quote.
- The little usage badge at the top of the screen reads these same numbers and changes color to warn the contractor: normal, yellow when they're getting low (3 or fewer trial days left, 2 or fewer quotes left, or past 80% of a paid plan's monthly quotes), and red when the trial is over or the monthly limit is hit. Unlimited plans just show an infinity symbol. The badge refreshes itself every minute so the days-left number stays honest.
- AI plan-reads are counted separately and enforced on the server, not in the browser, so the limit can't be dodged. When a contractor uploads a plan to be read, the server checks their plan and their used-count first, marks one read as used BEFORE calling the paid AI service, and only then does the work. This order matters: it stops someone from firing off many uploads at once to sneak past the cap.
- If the AI read fails or the plan page can't be read, the server gives that AI credit back, so a failed read doesn't cost the contractor anything. If they're genuinely out of AI reads for the month, it returns a clear 'you've used all your AI plan reads this cycle' message.
- Subscribing happens through Stripe's own secure checkout page. When a contractor picks a plan, the app sends them over to Stripe to enter payment; Anchor never touches card details itself. Choosing annual instead of monthly bills ten months' price for the year, so it works out to roughly two free months.
- After they pay, Stripe sends a signed message back to Anchor confirming the payment, and Anchor flips the account to the new plan and stamps when the next billing cycle resets. Anytime a subscription changes, renews, or is canceled, Stripe notifies Anchor and the account's allowances update to match. On each successful monthly renewal, the used-quote count is reset to zero for the fresh cycle.
- If a subscription is canceled, the account drops back to a no-quotes state and the app starts steering the user toward picking a plan again. Their saved jobs, settings, and rates are kept either way.
- Contractors who've already paid get a 'Manage subscription' option that opens Stripe's own portal, where they can upgrade, downgrade, change their card, cancel, or download invoices. Trial users don't see this, because they don't have a billing record yet.

### How it connects to the rest of the app

- The plan a contractor is on is the master switch for the rest of the app's premium features (AI plan-reads, the buck cut-list optimizer, e-signatures, shareable quote links, job photos, win/lost tracking and CSV export, custom branding) — those features look up this plan to decide whether to turn on.
- The quote counter is incremented by every 'new quote' action across the app, so the same allowance is shared no matter where a quote is started from.
- The AI plan-reader (the feature that scans a window schedule and pulls out the openings) checks with this billing brain on the server every time before it runs, and reports back when a read fails so the usage page can show where users are getting stuck.
- Plan status, used-counts, and the next-reset date all live on the contractor's saved profile, which syncs between their device and the cloud — so the badge and limits look the same whether they're online or come back later.
- Stripe is the source of truth for money: it runs checkout and the billing portal, and it pushes confirmations back to Anchor that set the plan and reset the monthly counters. Anchor trusts only signed messages from Stripe, so no one can fake an upgrade.
- The admin/owner account is recognized here and exempted from all limits, the same way it's treated as unlimited elsewhere in the app.

## Good numbers to know

- Free trial: 14 days, 8 quotes, and 5 AI plan-reads.
- Starter plan: $39/month (or $390/year) — 25 quotes and 2 AI plan-reads per month.
- Pro plan: $99/month (or $990/year) — 200 quotes and 100 AI plan-reads per month; marked 'Most popular'.
- Shop plan: $199/month (or $1990/year) — unlimited quotes and unlimited AI plan-reads.
- Annual billing charges ten times the monthly price, so a year costs about two months less than paying monthly.
- A paid billing cycle is 30 days; the used-quote count resets to zero each renewal.
- Usage badge turns yellow (low) at 3 or fewer trial days left, 2 or fewer quotes left, or once 80% of a paid month's quotes are used; turns red when the trial ends or the monthly limit is reached.
- Starter's AI read cap is deliberately low (2/month) to nudge frequent users up to Pro; the trial intentionally gives more (5) as a taste.
- Plan-read uploads are capped at 20 pages total and roughly 30 MB per upload.
- Decision order when blocking: trial expired beats lapsed payment, which beats the monthly quote limit. The owner's admin account is never blocked and never uses up a quote.
- A failed or unreadable AI plan-read is refunded, so it doesn't count against the monthly AI allowance.

# 12. AI Job Photos, Feedback & Security

*This part covers three things that sit "around" the quoting work: one-click branded job photos (a clean cover image for every job on your dashboard), the in-app feedback button (send the team a bug or a wish without leaving the app), and the behind-the-scenes guardrails that keep all of it safe and stop the paid features from being abused. None of it changes a price — it's the polish, the feedback loop, and the locks on the doors.*

### How it works

- AI job photo, step by step: when you hit Generate on a job tile, the app asks the server for a fresh, made-up photo of a Florida house. The server randomly picks one of six house styles (ranch, Mediterranean, Key West cottage, modern stucco, Spanish colonial, concrete-block) and one of four backdrops (blue sky with palms, golden-hour, manicured lawn, quiet street), then asks an outside image service to paint that exact scene — daytime, sharp, no people, no text, no watermark.
- The server hands the finished picture back to your browser as raw image data (not a web link). That detail matters: because it isn't pulled from someone else's web address, your browser is allowed to draw on top of it and re-save it without being blocked.
- Your browser then builds the thumbnail itself: it fits the house photo to fill a 16-by-10 frame, softens it with a blur, lays a dark wash and a soft center-out shadow over it for readability, then prints the job's name big, bold, and centered (shrinking the text and wrapping to at most two lines so long names still fit), draws a small gold underline, and adds the linear-feet total as a subtitle. The result is saved as that job's photo.
- The blur is done with plain math on the pixels rather than a built-in browser blur, on purpose — Safari quietly ignores the built-in one, so older thumbnails came out with no blur at all. Doing the math by hand means it looks identical on every phone and computer.
- Same treatment for a photo you upload yourself: it gets the blurred-background, title-on-top look so every dashboard tile matches — but with half the blur of an AI house (so your real job photo stays recognizable behind the name). Uploads are capped at about 12 MB.
- Feedback, step by step: you pick Bug or Feature, type a message, and send. The app bundles your message with some quiet context — your company name, your plan, the page you were on, your browser, and your screen size — and ships it to the server.
- The server does NOT trust what the page tells it about who you are. It looks up your real signed-in account and pulls your email and plan from your actual profile, so a report can't be faked to look like it came from someone else. It checks the message isn't empty and isn't longer than 4,000 characters, then files it.
- Once filed, the team gets an email notification (when email is switched on) and the report also shows up live in the owner's admin panel — newest first, with a count of how many are still open. The email is skipped silently if email isn't configured; it never blocks your report from being saved.
- Security thinking that runs under all of it — abuse caps: every AI photo costs real money, so the server counts them against a per-billing-cycle limit and subtracts one BEFORE it places the order. If two requests come in at once they still can't sneak past the cap, and if the image service fails the credit is handed back so you're not charged for nothing.
- Security thinking — real-user check: the app's public key is technically a valid pass to the building, so the server doesn't accept it alone. For both the photo generator and the feedback sender, it insists on resolving a genuine signed-in person, which is what actually keeps strangers from hammering the paid photo endpoint in a loop. The owner's account skips the photo caps.

- Security thinking — don't leak, don't trust text: when something goes wrong upstream, the detailed error is logged on the server only and you just see a plain 'try again' message. Anywhere the app shows text people typed (like feedback in the admin list), it neutralizes any HTML so a message can't run code in the owner's browser.
- Security thinking — safe exports and pages: the CSV pipeline export defuses any cell that starts with a formula character so opening it in Excel can't run something nasty, the analytics only ever send a trimmed, sanitized handful of values, the outside code libraries are version-pinned with fingerprints so a tampered copy won't load, and the site ships locked-down headers (can't be embedded in someone else's page, camera/mic/location/payment all switched off).
- Light/dark theming runs across all of it: your choice is remembered and applied before the first paint so there's no flash, and the toggle works even on the public pages before you sign in.

## How it connects to the rest of the app

- Job photos feed the Dashboard: the finished thumbnail is saved exactly like an uploaded job photo (stored in the cloud, not stuffed into the job record), so it shows on the job's dashboard tile and travels with the job.
- The thumbnail's subtitle pulls the job's linear-feet total straight from the saved job, and the big title uses the customer or job name — so the photo always reflects the real numbers from your quote.
- The AI photo caps are tied to your plan and billing cycle, the same plan/cycle system that powers the rest of the app's limits: trial and starter get a small allowance, pro gets a large one, top tier is unlimited, and the owner is exempt.
- Feedback is tied to your signed-in account and your saved company/brand and plan — it reads those from your profile, the same place your setup and subscription live — and lands in the owner's admin panel and (optionally) their inbox.
- The security guardrails wrap the paid AI features (job photos here, and the plan-reading photo analysis elsewhere) and the document tools (CSV export, the shareable sign/quote pages), so the same locks protect everything that costs money or shows other people's data.

## Good numbers to know

- AI house photos per billing cycle: trial 10, starter 10, pro 100, top tier unlimited; the owner has no limit.
- A photo costs a credit that's subtracted before the order is placed, and refunded automatically if the image service fails.
- Generation takes roughly 20 seconds; the server waits up to 60 seconds for the image before giving up.
- Thumbnail frame is 800 by 500 (16-by-10); the title shrinks and wraps to fit, never more than two lines.
- Blur strength: heavier on AI house photos, half as strong on real photos you upload so they stay recognizable.
- Uploaded job photos are capped at about 12 MB.
- Feedback messages are capped at 4,000 characters and can't be empty; your email and plan come from your real account, not from the page.
- Owner sees the newest 100 feedback items, with a live count of those still open; team email notification is best-effort and never blocks saving.
- Dark mode is the default; your light/dark choice is remembered between visits.

# 13. How We Make You Money

*Read this before you talk to a customer. The whole pitch rests on one honest idea: if your business doesn't make money, we don't make money. We only grow when you win more jobs, quote them faster, and keep more profit. Everything here is built around three promises — grow your revenue, give you your time back, and take the stress and busywork off your plate.*

### The deal we're making with you

Say this out loud to a prospect — it disarms them and it's true: “I only win if you win. This tool exists to put more money in your pocket and more hours back in your week. If it doesn't do that, you'll cancel and I'm out of business. So my incentive is 100% lined up with yours.” In B2B, aligned incentives close deals. Lead with it.

- Our goal, plainly: grow your revenue, cut your quoting time, and free you from the stress and monotony of bidding.
- We only make money if it keeps making you money. That's the relationship.

### 1) More revenue — win more of the jobs you bid

Speed is money. The contractor who gets a clean, professional number in front of the homeowner first usually wins.

- Quote in minutes, not hours — so you bid more jobs in the same week. More bids at the same close rate = more revenue.
- Never underbid by accident — it counts real materials, real labor hours, and real bucking lumber off the actual openings.
- Set your margin once and every quote prices itself for profit, automatically.
- Upsell with confidence — impact glass, sliding & bifold doors, and bucking all price correctly the moment you add them.

### 2) Time back — hours off every quote

The monotony of quoting is where contractors lose their evenings. We delete most of it.

- Snap or upload the window schedule and the AI reads it — counts, sizes, manufacturer, even the Florida approval numbers.
- Enter the job once and it flows everywhere: the breakdown, the customer quote, the cost sheet, the materials list, and the buck cut list. No re-typing.
- Every document generates instantly, ready to view, download, or send from your phone.

### 3) Less stress, less busywork

Quoting shouldn't feel like a second job at the kitchen table.

- No spreadsheet math errors — the formulas are locked and consistent on every job.
- Works on your phone, on the jobsite, the way you actually work.
- Save, reload, send for signature, track the pipeline — the admin runs itself so you can run the crew.

### 4) Look like the biggest shop in town

A polished quote signals a professional outfit and lets you hold your price.

- Branded customer quotes with your company name and a clean job thumbnail.
- Send a quote for a legally-binding e-signature and get notified the second the customer signs.

- Professional PDFs that make a one-truck operation look like a 20-crew company.

### 5) The Florida edge nobody else has

This isn't a generic calculator — it's built for how Florida actually inspects and installs.

- Instant Florida Product Approval (FL#) and Miami-Dade NOA lookup with the installation PDF right in the app.
- Fastener counts based on real product-approval screw spacing by manufacturer and impact rating — not a guess.
- Buck cut lists that turn a schedule into an exact lumber order — and size the rough opening correctly even when the plan doesn't list one.

### Pain points → how Anchor solves them

When a prospect names a pain, here's the answer:

- “Quoting eats my nights.” → Minutes per quote; the AI reads the schedule for you.
- “I underbid and lost money.” → Real material, labor, and bucking takeoffs so nothing gets left off.
- “My quotes look like a text message.” → Branded, professional PDFs and e-signatures.
- “I re-type the same job five times.” → Enter once, it flows everywhere.
- “The inspector wants the approval number.” → FL# / NOA lookup with the PDF, built in.
- “I never know my real margin.” → It shows true cost, selling price, and profit on every job.

### Say it in one breath

“Anchor turns a window schedule into a priced, branded, signable quote in minutes — with the materials, labor, and Florida-code bucking already figured out. You bid more jobs, stop underbidding, and get your evenings back. And we only make money if it's making you money.”

# 14. Key Numbers at a Glance

| Area | Rule / Number |
|---|---|
| Default margin | 35% added on top of your true cost to set the selling price (you can change it) |
| Window vs material footage | Your saved/quoted footage is windows only; materials also cover door frames so nothing's short |
| Caulk | 2.25 oz per linear foot |
| Wood bucking (estimate) | 1.25 per ft — block-framed jobs only (exact when you run the cut list) |
| Flashing tape | 1.0 per ft — stick-framed jobs only |
| Block sealer | 5 gallons per 300 ft, rounded up to full 5-gallon buckets |
| Crew (default) | 2 people at $30/hr = $60/hr crew cost |
| Setup + mobilization | 45 min per opening + a one-time 2 hours per job |
| Install speed (base) | ~10 min/ft stick new-construction · 25 min/ft block · 40 min/ft remodel |
| Height & impact | 2-story ×1.3, 3-story ×1.65, impact ×1.15 on install time |
| Buck head & sill | Cut to the EXACT masonry-opening width (they span the full opening top & bottom) |
| Buck jamb (window) | Masonry-opening height – 3 inches (tucks under head and sill) |
| Buck jamb (door) | Masonry-opening height – 1.5 inches (head only, no sill) |
| Masonry opening for bucking | Nominal/unit size +3.5" · labeled R.O. +3" · labeled M.O. as-is (W & H) → finished hole = window + 1/2" shim |
| Buck lumber | 2x6 pressure-treated in 16 / 12 / 10 / 8 ft, cut to waste the least |
| AI plan reads per month | Trial 5 · Starter 2 · Pro 100 (owner unlimited) |
| Plan prices | Starter $39 · Pro $99 · Shop $199 per month |
| R.O. vs M.O. | R.O. = window + 1/2" shim (stick-framed finished opening, no buck). M.O. = the block hole the buck boards frame. |